



MONTHLY UPDATE

Research institutions: monthly update, July 2026

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17 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.

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The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Burundi

The research capacity the AI strategy assumes showed itself once this month, [outside the state](#).

Cameroon

Two research builds were tabled in the same cabinet review list — a [sovereign scientific database on a dedicated national platform](#) and a [centre for the digitisation of scientific and technical information](#) — with no cost, site or timeline for either.

Central African Republic

Nothing moved in the research base this period. What changed is the record: the base had carried no university, statistics-institute or donor research document for the country at all, and now holds the University of Bangui's [Institut supérieur de technologie](#), which supplies most of the country's professional engineering graduates and runs a master's in engineering sciences. The page carries no date, enrolment or research-output figure, so the position it settles is one of existence rather than of scale.

Congo

Researchers and faculty met in Brazzaville on 21 and 22 August to [set rules for the use of artificial intelligence in research](#). No code, guideline text or adopting institution has come out of it yet.

Cote d'Ivoire

The cyber agency and a technology school validated curricula for two cyber-security master's degrees on 28 July, with enrolment stated for the September 2026 academic year and no intake size or funding published.

Equatorial Guinea

GITGE's deputy director-general presented [doctoral findings](#) at the AVANTE forum on 22 July on big data, interoperability and digital identity in the public administration, arguing that the constraint is structural gaps and elapsed time rather than technology.

Ethiopia

The FY2026/27 federal budget ratified on 7 July [carries Artificial Intelligence University Construction as a single named capital project at ETB 5,000,000,000](#) — domestic money, appropriated rather than pledged, and large enough to dominate the year's digital total on its own. A national AI policy was adopted in 2024 and the AI institute has operated since 2020.

Nothing moved on the national AI policy itself, on the model-development side, or on which foundation models the country runs.

Kenya

The base gained its first account of a named Kenyan data-science career, a [data-for-social-impact leader profiled](#) in a series of conversations with practitioners. It is an interview rather than an institutional record, and carries no programme, funding or output figure.

Libya

On 4 August the Libyan Authority for Scientific Research's scientific committee [approved an integrated cloud platform for higher education and scientific research](#), described in the authority's own account as using Microsoft 365.

Mozambique

At the university data centre's inauguration the communications minister proposed transferring management of the research and education network from his own ministry to the universities, naming no date, instrument or governance model ([ministerial account](#)).

Niger

The [Council of Ministers of 21 August 2026 took decisions on research and innovation](#). Cabinet conclusions name what is decided without carrying the text of it, so the base holds the announcement and not the instruments.

Rwanda

An [academic security operation centre is running through a university network based in Rwanda, described as operating on multiple levels to meet cybersecurity monitoring needs and to build a cybersecurity workforce in Rwanda and beyond](#). No monitored-estate, incident or staffing figure is published, so the size of what the centre actually does cannot be stated from the base.

Senegal

The council of ministers of 29 July [proposed a national research and innovation fund alongside applied research laboratories](#). Neither is an adopted instrument, and no budget or date attaches to either.

Somalia

The Somali National Bureau of Statistics closed a three-day technical workshop on 30 July under a [university research partnership](#), training researchers from three partner universities in methodology, statistical analysis and scientific writing, and in working with the bureau's own household budget and labour force microdata. It is a pilot funded by the Swiss development agency with no amount stated. What it implies about the constraint is the substantive part: official statistics exist and are being offered to domestic researchers, which puts the limit on evidence-based policy at national analytical capacity rather than at data collection.

South Africa

The month's one research measure is about the literature rather than the country. A twenty-year bibliometric review places South Africa 18th worldwide and the only African country among the twenty most productive sources of [digital-privacy research](#), across 4,760 articles published between 2005 and 2025. The same review finds refugees, people with disabilities, older people and racial and ethnic minorities notably underrepresented in that literature, so the ranking counts output and not coverage of the populations whose privacy is least protected.

Tanzania

A national institution of science and technology was [selected as the country's only member of the global AI capacity development network](#), announced at its graduation ceremony on 22 August 2026. The network is supported by the UN office for digital and emerging technologies, was itself launched in July 2026, and works across AI foundations, AI enablers, capacity development and open science.

Zambia

The revenue authority signed a research memorandum with an international tax and development centre on 17 July, accompanied by a non-disclosure agreement, so whether taxpayer microdata moves is not disclosed.

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